

Welcome to Wilderness First Aid

Dear Student,

We are delighted to have you join our Wilderness First Aid (WFA) course. Over the next two days, you will develop one of the most valuable skills an outdoor professional and enthusiast can possess: the ability to recognize, assess, and respond effectively to medical emergencies in remote environments where definitive medical care may be hours or days away.

This course is designed for everyone. You do not need any medical background or prior experience. Whether you are a guide, outdoor educator, backcountry enthusiast, or rescuer, this curriculum will prepare you to stay calm, make sound clinical decisions, and provide life-sustaining care.

By the end of this course, you will be able to:

- Perform a rapid, systematic patient assessment in any environment
- Recognize life-threatening conditions and provide immediate treatment
- Manage bleeding, airway compromise, and shock
- Make informed decisions about evacuation versus on-site treatment
- Stabilize musculoskeletal injuries and spine injuries
- Recognize and treat environmental emergencies (heat, cold, altitude)
- Communicate clearly with rescue personnel and hand off your patient safely

Our instructors are experienced outdoor professionals with real-world emergency response backgrounds. We use interactive scenarios, skills practice, and real equipment to make this course practical, engaging, and relevant.

Come ready to learn, practice, and challenge yourself. We look forward to training with you.

The WFA Course Team

Pre-Course Checklist

Please complete all items below before the start of your course. This preparation will help you get the most out of the two-day training.

■ Complete all 13 online pre-course lessons

Visit the course portal at [Instructor to add URL]. These lessons cover foundational concepts, terminology, and assessment frameworks. They take approximately 2-3 hours total.

■ Study the key mnemonics

Familiarize yourself with: XABCDE (primary survey), SAMPLE (history), OPQRST (pain assessment), AVPU (level of consciousness), DCAP-BTLS (trauma assessment), AEIOU-TIPS (altered mental status), FAST (stroke signs), MIST (handoff). Flashcards and videos are available online.

■ Read assigned textbook chapters

[Instructor to specify]. If you have a WFA textbook, read Chapters [TBD] before Day 1.

■ Physical preparation

You will kneel, crawl, practice carries, and spend time on the ground during skills practice. Wear comfortable, weather-appropriate clothing. Avoid tight jeans or clothes that restrict movement.

■ Get rest

Sleep well the night before. The course is physically and mentally intensive.

What to Bring

Please bring the following items to ensure you are prepared and comfortable:

Required:

- Two pairs of nitrile gloves in your size (these will be incorporated into your personal first aid kit)
- Pen and small notepad (for documenting patient assessments)
- Water bottle (bring plenty of water)
- Snacks (we will provide lunch, but bring energy snacks for breaks)
- Layered clothing appropriate for the expected weather
- Sturdy shoes with good ankle support (you will be on your feet and on the ground)

Optional but Helpful:

- Your personal first aid kit or contents (if you have one — we will evaluate it together for gaps and improvements)
- Your personal EpiPen or medications (for discussion purposes only; we will not administer them)
- A headlamp or flashlight (useful for low-light scenarios)
- Sunscreen and bug spray
- Any medications or first aid supplies you use regularly (inhaler, glucose meter, etc.)

What NOT to bring: *Phones should be silenced (or left behind). If you have a medical condition that requires medication or monitoring, please notify the instructors at the start of Day 1.*

Course Schedule Overview

This schedule is approximate and may vary based on class pace and discussion. Day 1 focuses on foundational assessment and life-threat management. Day 2 builds on these skills with environmental and specialized emergencies.

DAY 1 SCHEDULE

Module	Topic	Time
1	Provider Safety, Legal Issues, Scene Safety	~0.5 hr
2	Patient Assessment & History (XABCDE, SAMPLE)	~1 hr
3	Airway, Breathing, Circulation	~1.5 hrs
4	Hemorrhage & Wound Management	~1 hr
5	Shock	~0.75 hr
6	Musculoskeletal Injuries	~1.5 hrs
	Day 1 Total: ~6-7 hrs (includes breaks)	

DAY 2 SCHEDULE

Module	Topic	Time
7	Head & Spine Injuries	~1.25 hrs
8	Heat-Related Illness	~0.75 hr
9	Cold-Related Illness & Hypothermia	~1 hr
10	Anaphylaxis & Allergic Reactions	~0.75 hr
11	Medical Emergencies (AEIOU-TIPS)	~1 hr
12	Bites, Stings & Envenomation	~0.75 hr
13	Evacuation & Rescue	~1 hr
	Capstone Scenarios & Skills Stations	~1.5 hrs
	Written Exam & Review	~1 hr
	Day 2 Total: ~8-9 hrs (includes breaks)	

This schedule is approximate and may vary.

Assessment & Certification

Successful completion of the WFA course requires demonstration of both knowledge and practical skills.

What You Will Be Assessed On:

Written Exam (30-40 questions)

Tests your understanding of assessment frameworks, treatment protocols, decision-making, and environmental emergencies.

Skills Assessments (Throughout course)

Practical demonstration of: patient assessment, tourniquet application, wound management, rescue breathing, splinting, spinal stabilization, and ability to lead a team through a patient encounter and evacuation decision.

Passing Requirements:

- Written exam: **75% or higher (30 out of 40 questions)**
- Skills assessment: **Satisfactory performance** on all core competencies (as determined by instructor)
- Course participation: Full attendance both days (absences may require remediation)

If You Don't Pass:

If you do not meet the passing standard, we will offer remediation options, which may include: retaking the written exam, additional skills practice with an instructor, or attending a follow-up workshop. We are committed to your success.

Your Certificate:

Upon successful completion, you will receive a Wilderness First Aid certificate valid for **[Instructor to specify: typically 2-3 years]**. Your certificate demonstrates competency in wilderness emergency assessment and care. It is widely recognized by outdoor organizations, guide services, and rescue agencies.

Recertification is required every 2-3 years. We recommend staying current with your skills through practice, case reviews, and refresher training.

Questions?

If you have questions before the course, please contact:

Instructor Name: [To be filled in]

Email: [To be filled in]

Phone: [To be filled in]

We look forward to seeing you soon!